

Moab/Grand County Safe Streets for All (SS4A) Safety Action Plan

Technical Memorandum #2 – Community Assessment

August 5, 2026

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Introduction

The City of Moab and Grand County, was awarded a Safe Streets and Roads for All (SS4A) planning and demonstration grant from the U.S. Department of Transportation. The City of Moab, in conjunction with Grand County, is using this grant to update the 2022 co-jurisdictional Unified Transportation Master Plan: An Action Plan to Improve Safety for All (UTMP) to enhance strategies to reduce or eliminate roadway fatalities and serious injuries on streets and roadways throughout the City of Moab and Grand County. The Safety Action Plan (SAP) also provides additional analyses and improvement identification and concepting for three critical corridors in the City and County: Mill Creek Drive, Spanish Valley Drive, and Spanish Trail Road.

Purpose and Context

Transportation systems do not serve all residents equally. Barriers such as high-speed roads, limited multimodal infrastructure, and long distances between destinations can make it difficult for many residents to safely and reliably reach daily needs, especially lower income residents, children, older adults, people with disabilities, and those without access to a vehicle.

Infrastructure barriers contribute to transportation insecurity, where individuals face limited, unsafe, or unreliable options for accessing jobs, services, and community destinations.

This community assessment is intended to better understand transportation barriers in Moab City and Grand County and evaluate how proposed improvements may address them. Specifically, this community assessment aims to answer the following questions:

- Who lives in and around the study area corridors?
- Where do underrepresented or marginalized populations live?
- What infrastructure barriers limit safe and reliable travel, particularly for vulnerable users?
- How does access to essential destinations vary across the community?
- How do proposed corridor improvements affect safety and access?
- Which populations benefit most from proposed improvements, and are any groups left out?

To answer these questions, this assessment builds on the existing conditions analysis, Road Safety Audit (RSA), and the draft corridor concepts by incorporating demographic and socioeconomic data with spatial analysis of the transportation network. This includes identifying where residents with greater transportation needs may be concentrated, mapping gaps and barriers in the existing multimodal system, and evaluating access to essential destinations such as schools, parks, grocery stores, and employment centers.

By linking community characteristics with transportation conditions, Memorandum 2: Community Assessment provides a data-driven foundation for supporting the corridor concepts. The goal is

for proposed infrastructure improvements to not only enhance overall safety and connectivity, but also meaningfully reduce transportation insecurities and improve access for those who face the greatest barriers to mobility

Community Profile

Study Area Overview

The City of Moab and Grand County SS4A study area focuses on the following three roadway corridors identified in the UTMP as needing detailed assessments to enhance safety, multimodal connectivity, and mobility:

- Mill Creek Drive from 400 East to US-191
- Spanish Valley Drive from Mill Creek Drive to the Grand County Border
- Spanish Trail Road from US-191 to Murphy Lane

For this assessment, the analysis focuses on an area defined as a 0.5-mile buffer around the identified priority corridors. However, to fully understand the transportation safety context, the community assessment examines demographic and socioeconomic conditions across both the City of Moab and Grand County as a whole.

Moab's geography contributes to its transportation network, population distribution, and growth transformation patterns. The city is located in a narrow valley between red rock canyon walls, with the Colorado River to the east and US Highway 191 (US 191) serving as the primary north-south spine. The concentration of commercial activity along Main Street (US 191), combined with limited east-west connectivity, creates a street network that funnels both residents and visitors along critical corridors highlighted within the Safety Action Plan.

Demographic and Socioeconomic Characteristics

The City of Moab is a small but regionally significant municipality in southeastern Utah. According to the 2024 American Community Survey (ACS) 5-Year Estimates, Moab's population is approximately 5,312 residents, while Grand County is home to approximately 9,754 residents. Therefore, the city is home to the majority of the County's population within a much smaller geographic footprint. This reflects Moab's role as the primary urban center for the region.

This density distinction matters for transportation. Moab's residents live closer together, travel shorter distances for daily needs, and are more likely to use or be affected by the pedestrian and bicycle infrastructure that this SAP assesses. Meanwhile, County residents outside the Moab City limits often depend on US 191, Mill Creek Drive, and Spanish Valley Drive to access jobs, services, and amenities that are more concentrated in the City. The corridors function both as regional connectors and local streets, bringing together local and regional traffic, making safe street design a regional, not just municipal, concern.

This community assessment deliberately narrows the focus to populations who experience transportation infrastructure differently, and often more dangerously, than the general public. Underrepresented or marginalized populations are not simply demographic subgroups, but they are people most likely to walk or bike out of necessity, most exposed to the consequences of inadequate infrastructure, and least represented in traditional planning processes.

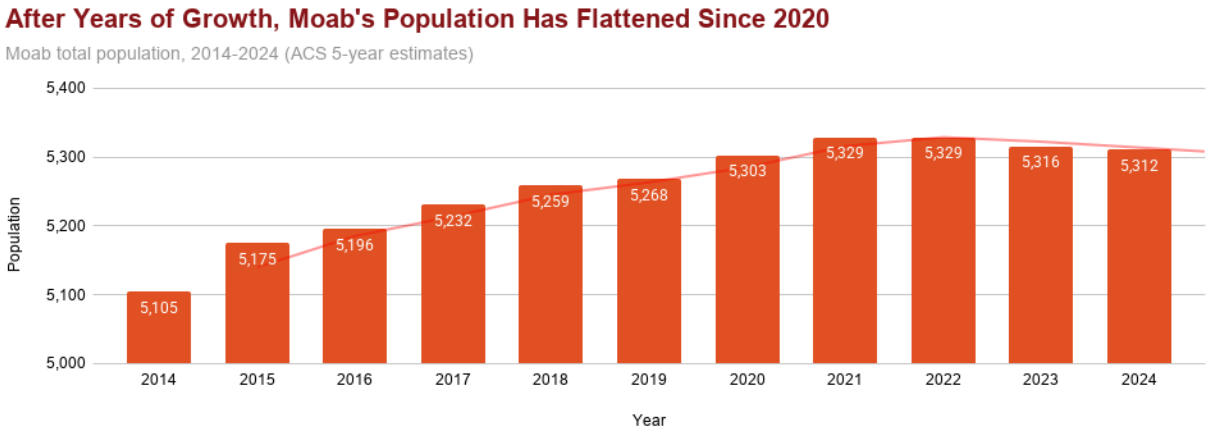
Data Constraint

The 2024 ACS 5-Year Estimates provide the most recent demographic data but do not provide reliable breakdowns at the neighborhood or census tract level. For this reason, the demographic analysis that follows presents data at the city and county levels, which represent the most statistically reliable estimates currently available.

The American Community Survey (ACS) 5-Year Estimates combine data collected continuously over a 5-year period to produce reliable statistics for small geographic areas, including rural counties, small towns, and census tracts, where a single year's sample wouldn't be large enough for accurate figures. Because they pool five years of responses, these estimates trade timelines for precision and produce the most reliable data.

Population and Growth Trends

The City of Moab has experienced modest, but steady population growth over the past two decades. The City grew from approximately 4,779 residents in 2000 to 5,312 in 2024, an 11.2% increase. Similarly, Grand County grew from 8,485 residents in 2000 to 9,754 by 2024, a 15% increase. *Figure 1* below shows the annual population growth in Moab City and Grand County.



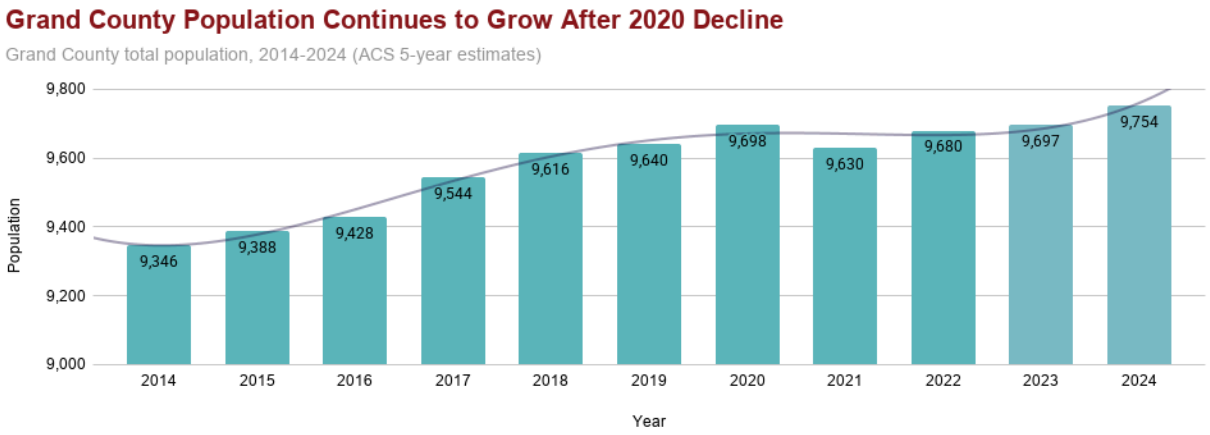


Figure 1. City of Moab and Grand County Annual Population

The Utah Governor's Office of Management and Budget has projected the City of Moab to grow by almost 24% over the next two decades, an addition of approximately 1,300 residents. This growth trajectory increases the urgency of investing in safe transportation infrastructure before demand outpaces capacity.

Population growth in the area has primarily been driven by the area's outdoor recreation economy and quality of life, attracting new residents such as remote workers, retirees, and second-home owners. This growth dynamic has important implications for transportation. It puts additional pressure on existing infrastructure, increases visitor and non-resident traffic on local streets, and contributes to rising housing costs that may force lower-income residents further from jobs, services, and other daily destinations.

Underrepresented and Marginalized Populations

Table 1. Underrepresented and Marginalized Populations in the City of Moab and Grand County

Category	Definition	Source Table (2024 ACS 5-Year Estimates)	Grand County	Moab City
Age (youth)	Residents under 18 years old	B09001	1,884 19.3%	1,172 22.1%
Age (elderly)	Residents 65 years old or older	B01001	1,958 20.1%	941 17.7%
Income	Residents* in households with income under $49,999 (75% AMI)	S1901 B25010	3,507 36%	2094 39%
Race/Ethnicity	Residents who are non-white and/or Hispanic	B03002	2,181 22.4%	1,533 28.9%
English Proficiency	Residents with limited English	C16001	346	302

	proficiency (speaks English less than "very well")		3.5%	5.7%
Disability	Residents with a disability	B18101	1,373 14.1%	659 12.4%
Vehicle Access	Residents* in households with zero vehicles	B25044 B25010	532 5.5% (252 units)	456 8.6% (214 units)
Housing availability	Residents* living in crowded households (HUD definition of crowding: Occupied units with more than 1 occupant per room)	B25014 B25010	411 4.2% (195 units)	343 6.5% (161 units)

*Calculated by multiplying the number of households and the average household size:

- Grand County (B25010): Average household size: 2.11
- Moab City (B25010): Average household size: 2.13

Age Distribution

The City of Moab and Grand County's age profile differs notably from the rest of Utah, with a median age of 36 in the City of Moab and 41 in Grand County, compared to 32 statewide. This concentration of older adults is especially notable: Grand County's senior population (20.1%) is nearly double than the statewide share (11.1%) and Moab is not far behind at 17.7%. Older adults often have difficulty driving or choose not to drive, making walkable streets and accessible pedestrian infrastructure essential to their mobility and independence. At the same time, the City of Moab has a meaningful share of youth (21.1%) who depend on safe routes to walk or bike to school, parks, and community spaces.

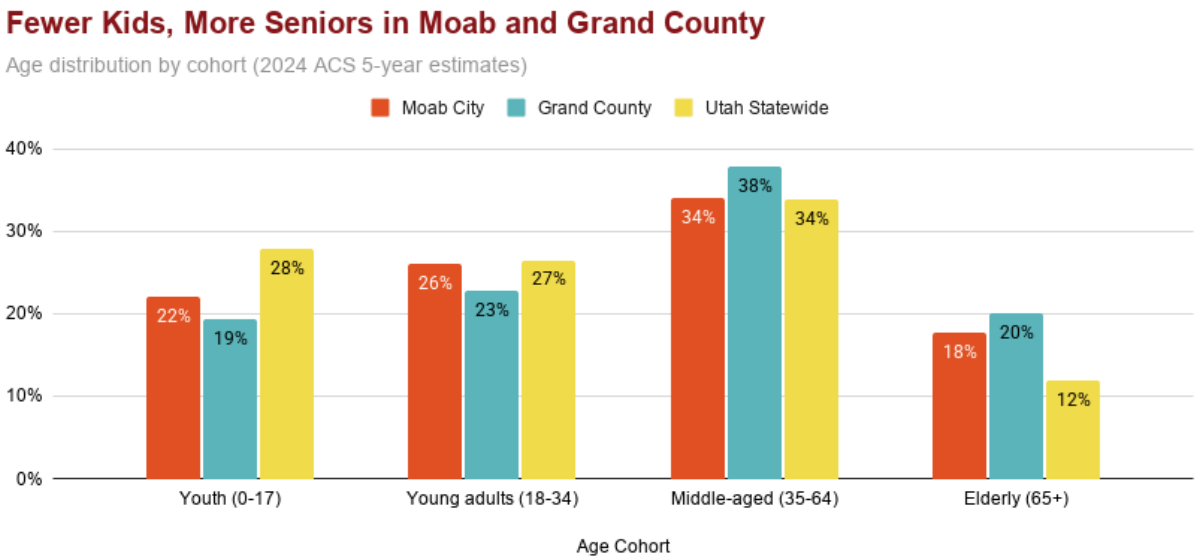


Figure 2. 2024 ACS Age Distribution

Income and Economic Characteristics

The area's economy is dominated by tourism and outdoor recreation, which generates significant visitor spending but tends to produce seasonal, lower-wage employment for residents. As a result, approximately 39% of Moab City residents and 36% of Grand County residents live in households earning under $49,999 annually.

Low-income residents are disproportionately dependent on walking, biking, and public transit for their daily transportation needs. Consequently, they are more exposed to traffic-related risks. Unsafe streets are not a neutral inconvenience. For cost-burdened households, they represent a barrier to employment, education, healthcare, and community participation.

Language and English Proficiency

An estimated 5.7% of Moab residents and 3.5% of Grand County residents speak English less than "very well." The most widely spoken non-English language in Moab and Grand County is Spanish. Residents with limited English proficiency may face barriers in understanding traffic safety signage, navigating temporary detours such as closures or construction, or accessing information about planned transportation improvements.

Disability Status

12.4% of Moab residents (approximately 659 individuals) and 14.1% of Grand County residents (approximately 1,373 individuals) live with a disability. Disability rates also increase with age: Approximately 30% of Moab residents over 65 live with a disability. This has direct implications for street design, accessibility, smooth sidewalk surfaces, and adequate crossing times are critical accessibility features for enabling safe and independent travel for people with disabilities while also creating a more comfortable and convenient walking experience for all users.

Equity Index Mapping

Equity Index Mapping is an analysis that identifies areas of higher need in Grand County and City of Moab by mapping historically marginalized or underrepresented population groups. The results are synthesized into a single Equity Priority Index, allowing multiple demographic and socioeconomic factors to be evaluated together. The purpose of the Equity Priority Index is to highlight where transportation investments can most effectively improve safety and access for those with the greatest need.

Methodology

The Equity Priority Index is based on the methodology developed by the Wasatch Front Regional Council (WFRC) for its 2024 Comprehensive Safety Action Plan[1], adapted slightly to reflect conditions in Moab. The only change is a different poverty metric was used for Moab. It

[1] WFRC Comprehensive Safety Action Plan

combines multiple demographic and socioeconomic indicators into a single measure to identify priority areas for investment and planning.

The analysis combines data from two different Census geographies. Population, age, and race/ethnicity are drawn from the 2020 Census blocks, the smallest available geography, which serves as the base unit for comparing neighborhoods. However, the priority index also requires income, vehicle access, and disability data, which the Census Bureau only publishes at the block group level via the 2024 ACS 5-year estimates.

Census blocks and block groups differ substantially in scale. A block is the smallest geographic unit that the Census Bureau defines. The blocks are roughly equivalent to a city block in urban areas. Block groups are the next level up, typically consisting of several dozen blocks and containing between about 600-3,000 people. This size difference is exactly why the Census Bureau publishes different types of data at each level. Blocks are small enough to support full-count decennial data like population, age, and race. They are too small statistically to support the sample based estimates from the ACS like income, vehicle access, and disability data which are released at the block group level.

To estimate these values at the block level, block group data were distributed to individual blocks based on population. In other words, blocks were assigned a share of each demographic characteristic proportional to their share of the block group population, using 2020 Census data. This approach assumes that these characteristics are spread evenly within each block group and that population patterns have not changed significantly between 2020 and 2024. As such, block-level values are estimates intended to show general patterns rather than exact counts.

The formula's variables represent:

- **Yth:** Number of residents under 18 years old
- **Eld:** Number of residents over 65 years old
- **NH:** Number of non-White and/or Hispanic residents
- **LEP:** Number of residents with limited English proficiency
- **Dis:** Number of residents with a disability
- **Pov:** Number of households with income below $49,999
- **Veh:** Number of households without zero vehicles
- **Crwd:** Number of households with more than 1 occupant per room
- **HH:** Average household size

$$Index = \frac{(Yth + Eld + NH + LEP + Dis + (Pov * HH) + (Veh * HH) + (Crwd * HH)}{Pop}$$

The Equity Priority Index map (Figure 3 and 4) combines all demographic values into a single, normalized metric that can be compared across census tracts. Higher index values (shown in darker purple) represent areas with a greater concentration of residents who may experience

transportation insecurity, including those with limited access to a personal vehicle, disabilities, lower incomes, or age-related mobility constraints. Lower values (lighter colors) indicate areas with comparatively fewer individuals experiencing transportation insecurity. These are often younger individuals or those with access to a personal vehicle.

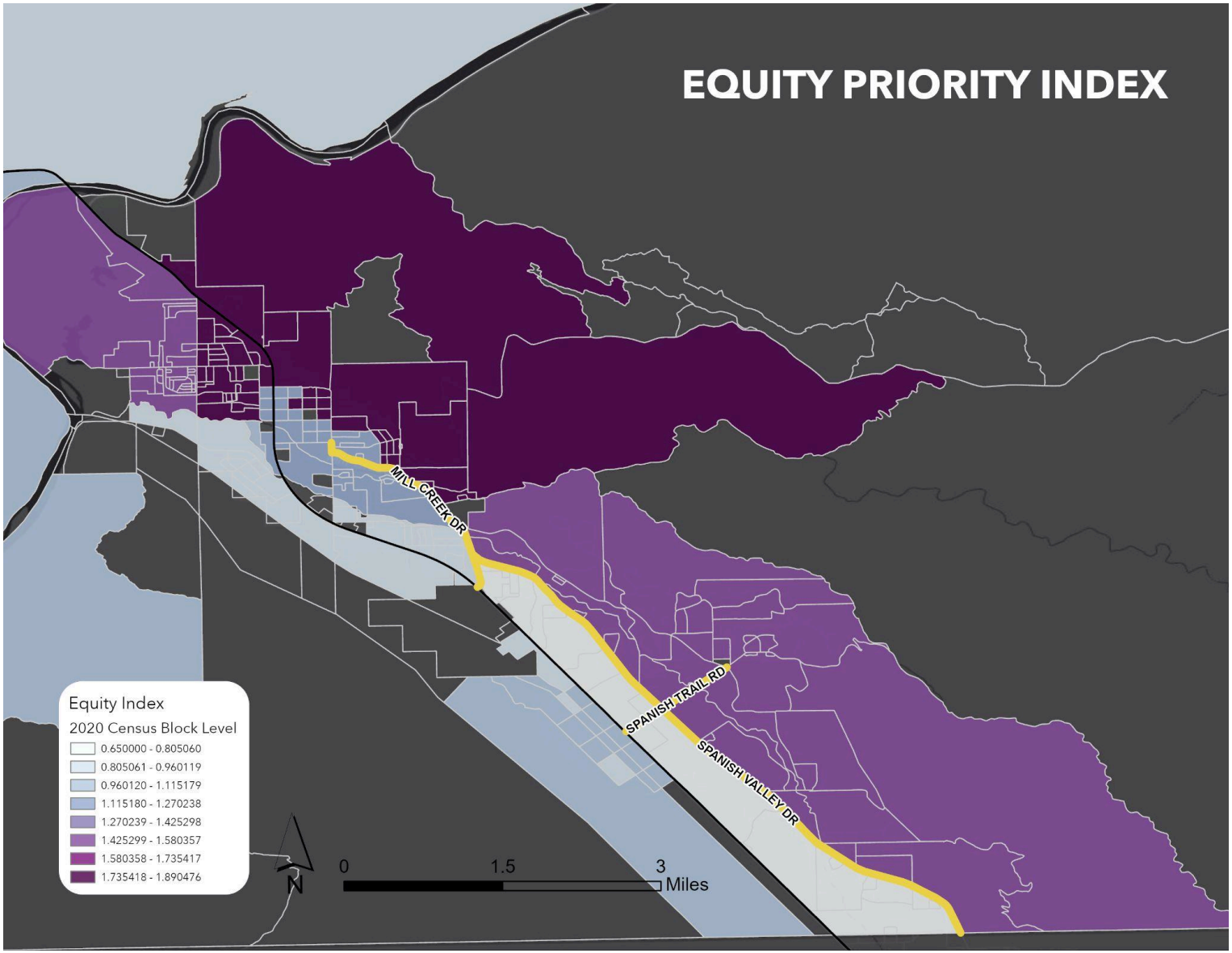


Figure 3. Equity Priority Index for Moab and Grand County

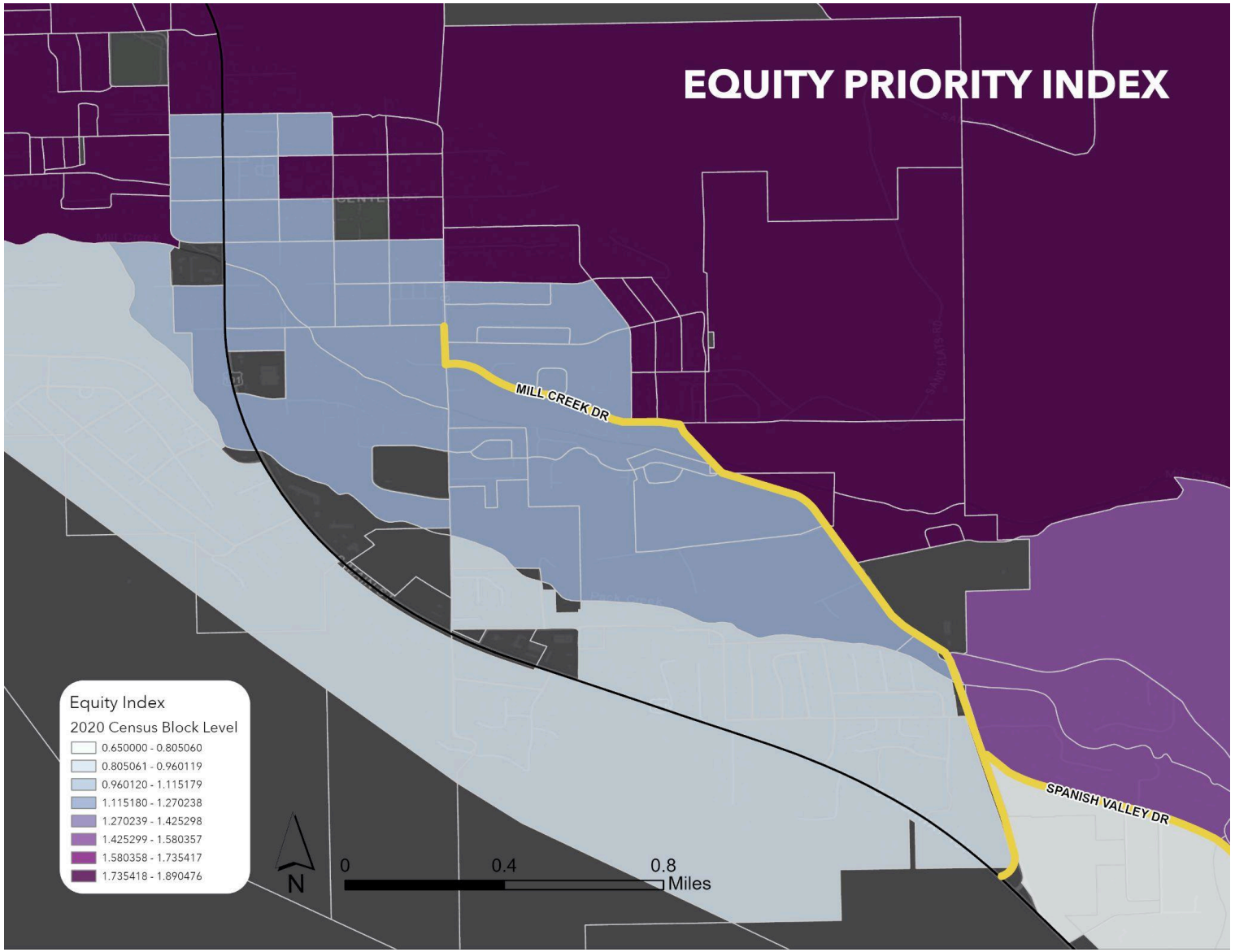


Figure 4. Equity Priority Index for Moab and Grand County (Zoomed View)

Key Findings

Overall, the map shows that transportation needs are clustered in specific parts of the community, often farther away from key destinations and corridors.

The **northeast edge of Moab** shows higher index values. Neighborhoods in this area include predominantly single-family housing as well as the Rockridge Senior Housing community. Residents in this area are more likely to rely on walking or biking yet are relatively removed from the primary commercial and service destinations (education facilities, healthcare, grocery and retail, and senior and affordable housing). This spatial mismatch increases the importance of safe and connected routes, linking these neighborhoods to key areas of the community.

The **west side of downtown** between 100 West and 500 West also shows higher index values. This area includes many commercial destinations along Main Street (US-191) as well as Helen M. Knight Elementary School and Moab Regional Hospital. Safe street design in this area is critical in providing access to essential services, particularly for children and older adults traveling to school or healthcare services.

The **downtown corridor** along Main Street (US-191), between 200 North and the Millcreek Drive intersection, shows a mix of moderate to low index values, reflecting a more economically and demographically mixed population. While fewer residents in this area may experience transportation insecurities themselves, it remains one of the region's important activity centers, with access to jobs, retail, and services.

Similarly, the **central Moab City area**, which includes Margaret L. Hopkin Middle School, Grand County High School, City Market, and the Millers Shopping Center, falls largely within moderate index ranges. These destinations generate significant daily travel demand, including trips by students and workers who may live in higher-need areas elsewhere in the City or County.

Along the **study area corridors** (Mill Creek Drive, Spanish Valley Drive, and Spanish Trail Road), higher index values are generally located to the north, with lower values to the southeast of Mill Creek Drive and Spanish Valley Drive. This indicates that the study area corridors function as boundaries between areas with differing levels of transportation needs. As a result, crossing these corridors safely becomes especially important as residents in higher-need areas may often travel across these corridors to access schools, services, and commercial areas.

The equity index findings suggest two priorities for transportation investments:

1. Areas with higher index values should be prioritized for investments that support safe and comfortable walking and biking experiences as residents in these areas are more likely to depend on active modes of travel.
2. Safe connections between high-need neighborhoods and key destinations in lower-need areas are critical, particularly to downtown, schools, and major services.

The following section builds on these findings through a gap analysis of Moab's active transportation network, identifying where barriers to key destinations exist. The equity index helps inform how access and connectivity vary across different parts of the community and among different population groups.

Gap Analysis

High Risk Network

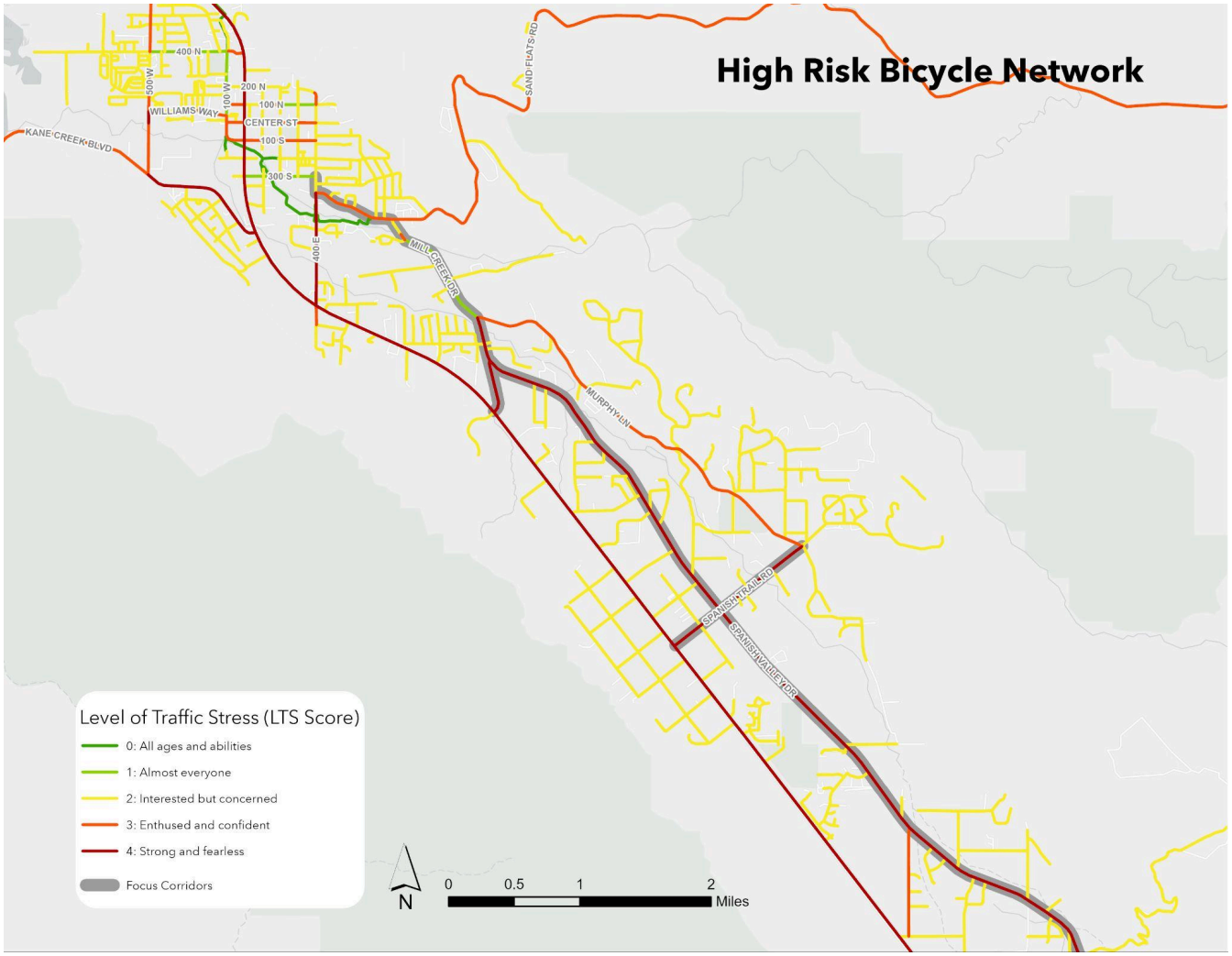


Figure 5. High Risk Network

Level of Traffic Stress (LTS) is a framework designed by the Wasatch Front Regional Council (WFRC) for measuring how comfortable a street or path is for biking considering roadway characteristics such as vehicle speed, traffic volume, number of lanes, and type(s) of bike facilities. LTS is measured on a scale from 0 to 4 and indicates which types of riders would feel comfortable biking along routes of different stress levels:

- **LTS 0**: All Ages and Abilities - No-stress, fully separated paths with no vehicle interaction. Safe and comfortable for users of all ages and abilities.
- **LTS 1**: Almost Everyone - Very low-stress conditions suitable for nearly all users. Roads typically have low traffic speeds/volumes and minimal conflict with motor vehicles.
- **LTS 2**: Interested but Concerned - Low-stress environments that are comfortable for many adults but may not be suitable for children or less confident riders. Includes calm, neighborhood streets and painted bike lanes on streets with moderate traffic conditions.
- **LTS 3**: Enthused and Confident - Moderate-stress conditions that are generally suitable for confident riders. Includes streets with higher speeds and volumes, narrow or unprotected bike lanes, and frequent conflicts with vehicles.
- **LTS 4**: Strong and Fearless - High-stress environments that are uncomfortable for most people. Includes roads with high speeds/volumes, no bike lanes, and significant vehicle exposure.

The WFRC has published a Utah Bikeways - Level of Traffic Stress[2] document that outlines the LTS scoring methodology and explains how scores are assigned within the Utah Bikeways dataset maintained by the Utah Geospatial Resource Center (UGRC). The LTS scores shown in *Figure 5* were drawn from Moab's common data database, provided to us by the city.

Network Gaps

Even a well-developed system of bicycle lanes, sidewalks, and shared-use paths can fail to serve its intended purpose if critical segments are missing, if facilities end abruptly before reaching a destination, or if key crossings lack safe accommodations. This gap analysis identifies the study area's existing and planned transportation networks and where transportation gasps may be located. For the purpose of this analysis, a gap is defined as a section of missing active transportation infrastructure between existing facilities, or a missing extension to a logical destination.

Gaps are categorized as either:

- **Spot gaps**: Key crossings or intersections with deficiencies in pedestrian or bicycle accommodations, or
- **Linear gaps**: Missing segments of bike lane, sidewalk, or shared use path that break continuity between existing facilities.

Linear gaps can be experiential, where a facility exists but the conditions are insufficient for its intended users, or planning gaps, where strategic extensions of the network to key destinations have not yet been built. Reducing or ultimately eliminating network gaps is essential to building a network that functions for all users, connects high-need neighborhoods to key destinations,

[2] Utah Bikeways - Level of Traffic Stress

and makes walking and biking a safe and viable choice for users. This analysis is intended to help the City and County identify and prioritize infrastructure investments to address the most critical gaps first.

Bicycle Facilities

The City and County's existing bicycle network provides a foundation for active transportation, but gaps remain that limit its effectiveness as a connected region-wide system. Addressing these gaps should be prioritized for locations where improvements would connect networks and maximize connectivity.

An LTS analysis was applied to the existing bicycle network to identify gaps and barriers to safe, comfortable bicycling.

The roadways listed in *Table 2* were identified as priority corridors for bicycle infrastructure improvements based on their role in network connectivity, LTS rating, and the populations they currently or could potentially serve. The following *Figure 6* and *Figure 7* show existing and planned facilities pulled from the Grand County Non-motorized Trails Master Plan[3] produced by Alta Consultants.

The existing network is largely concentrated along shared-use paths and limited bike lanes near the City's core. Namely, the shared-use path leading from 100 West, south onto Mill Creek Parkway, under Main Street, and eastward toward Rotary Park serves as the City's primary bicycle spine. It is recommended the City continue to connect this facility to the surrounding neighborhoods with safe and accessible routes. Considering the study corridors' roles of connecting residents from higher-need neighborhoods to services, prioritizing bicycle infrastructure projects on these corridors is essential in creating a strong and safe bicycle network in the City of Moab and Grand County.

Table 2. Bicycle Facility Gaps

North-South Corridors	East-West Corridors
• 500 West • Main Street/US-191 • 200 East • Mill Creek Drive • Spanish Valley Drive • Murphy Lane	• 400 North • 100 North • Center Street • 100 South • 200 South • Williams Way • Spanish Trail Rd • Middle/High School area (Kane Creek Boulevard/US-191 to Mill Creek Trail)

[3] Grand County Non-Motorized Trails Master Plan

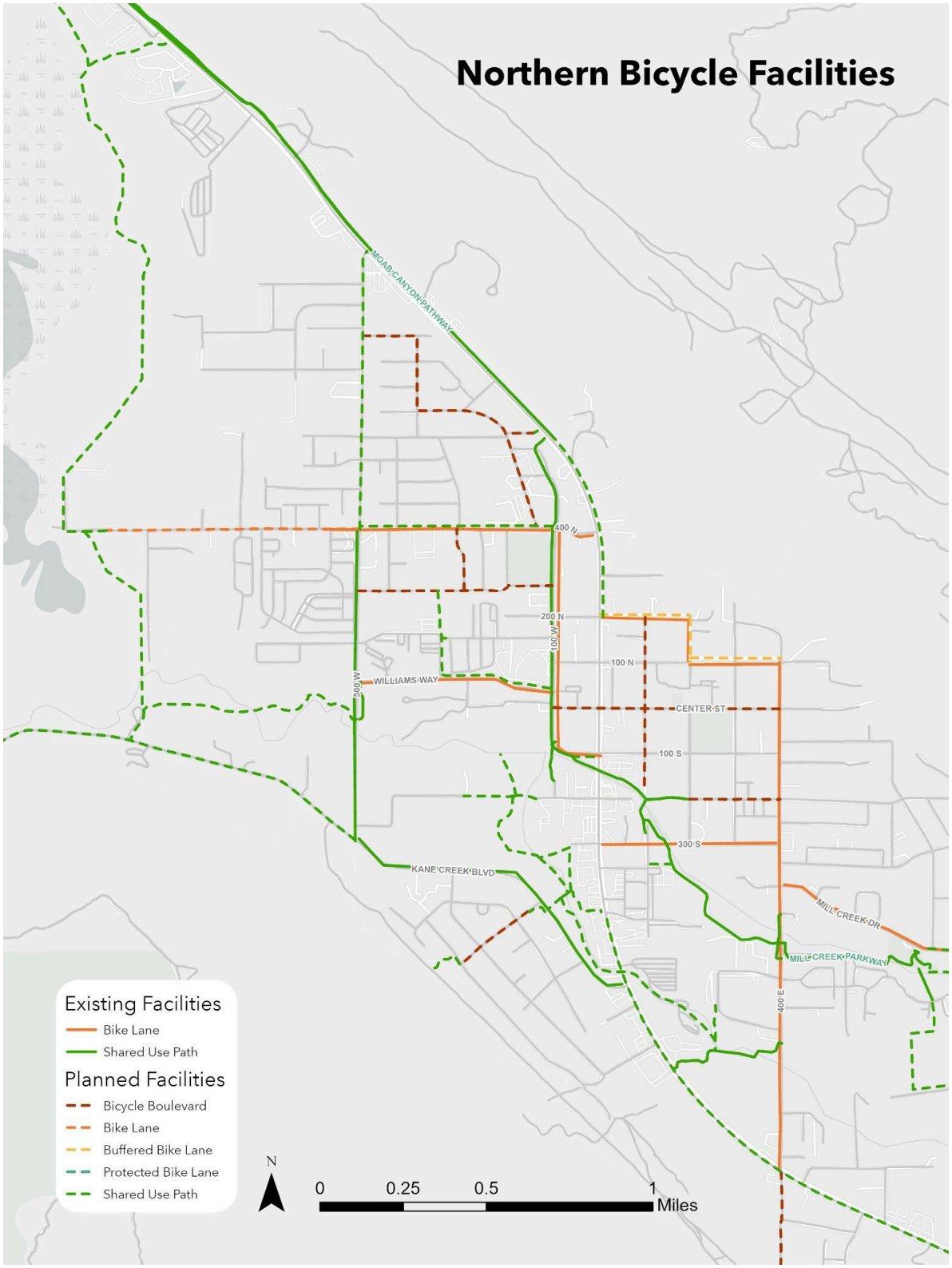


Figure 6. Existing and Planned Bicycle Facilities in Moab and Grand County (Northern)

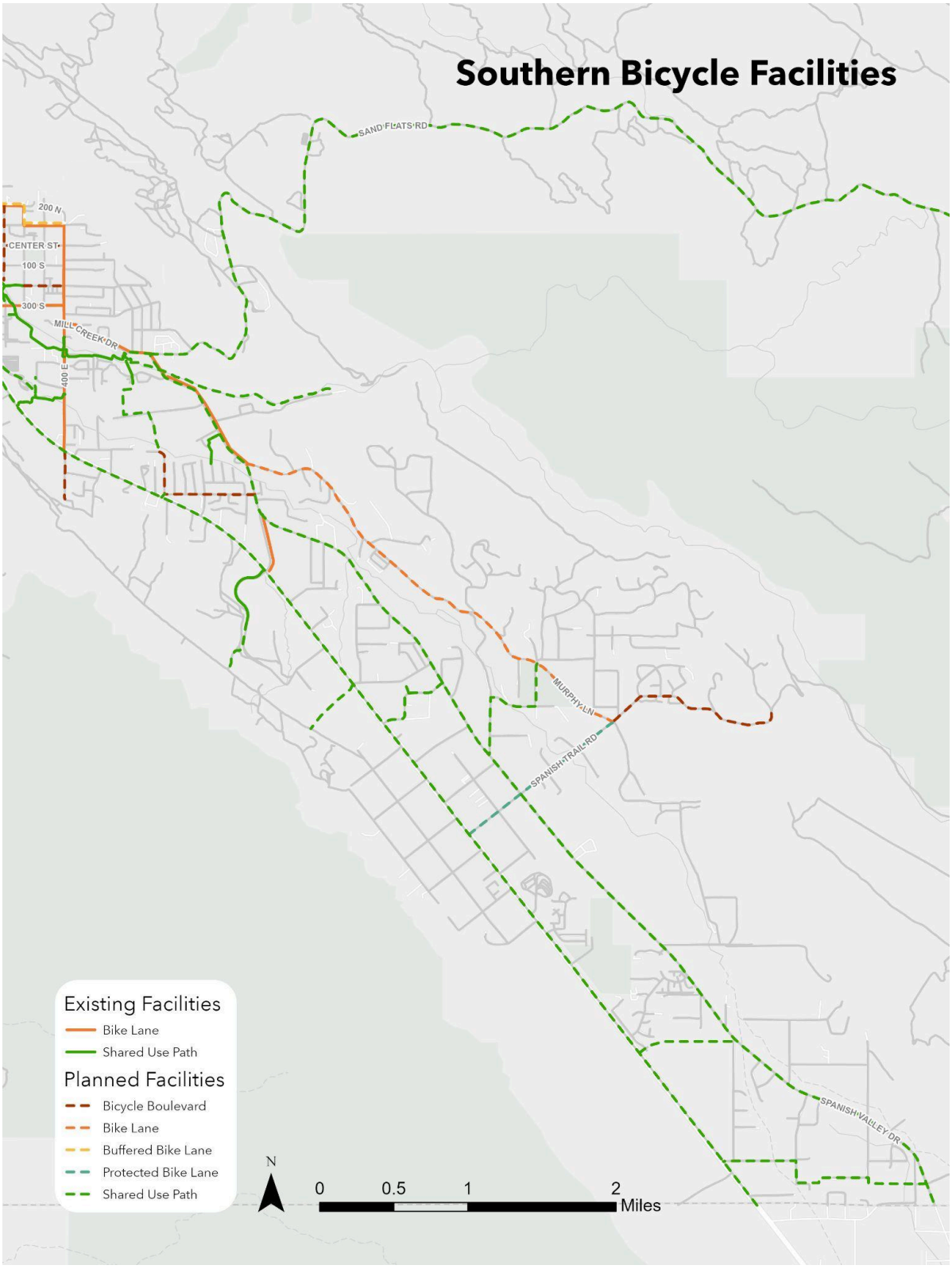


Figure 7. Existing and Planned Bicycle Facilities in Moab and Grand County (Southern)

Pedestrian Facilities

Sidewalks and safe crossings are foundational elements of a walkable community and create accessible environments for all users. They provide dedicated spaces for pedestrians that are comfortable, accessible, and separated from motor vehicle and bicycle traffic. Sidewalks and safe crossings help reduce pedestrian-vehicle crashes and can increase the potential of people choosing to walk.

However, not every road requires a sidewalk, especially in a more rural, small community context like the City of Moab and Grand County. As shown in *Figure 8*, sidewalks are recommended in all but the most low-speed and low volume roadways and are most appropriate in built-up areas along roadways where pedestrian activity is expected. Many local residential streets carry low enough volumes and have low speeds where pedestrians and vehicles share the roadway without dedicated pedestrian infrastructure. In these cases, traffic calming measures and low posted speed limits are often sufficient to create a safe walking environment without the cost and ROW that is typically associated with a full sidewalk network.

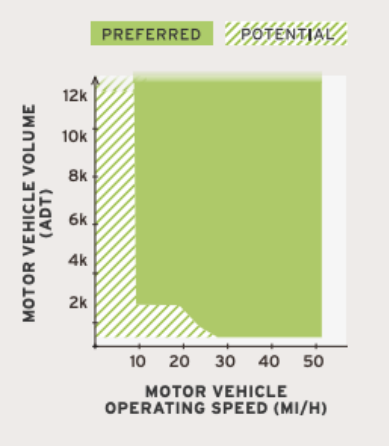


Figure 8. Sidewalk Placement Matrix

Primary corridors and high pedestrian use roadways (such as those near Main Street and within the City of Moab's downtown core) should have sidewalks on both sides of the street. Safe and visible crossings should also be available at intersections within these areas. These considerations are especially important for streets with higher traffic speeds and volumes, where pedestrians may otherwise feel unsafe and avoid walking.

The following GIS data was gathered from the City of Moab's data package. It is important to note that sidewalk and crossing data was only available for Moab City at the time of the assessment. *Figure 9* does not fully represent conditions further south or outside of Moab City limits.

This analysis identifies two primary pedestrian infrastructure needs: sidewalk gaps within the City of Moab core and the study area corridors where there may be gaps in the existing network, and missing or deficient crossings on identified barrier roads where pedestrians are required to cross high-stress corridors to reach key destinations. These two pedestrian infrastructure gap types represent the most critical near-term investments for improving pedestrian safety and connectivity in the region. Results of the pedestrian gap analysis show sidewalk and crossing gaps in *Table 3*.

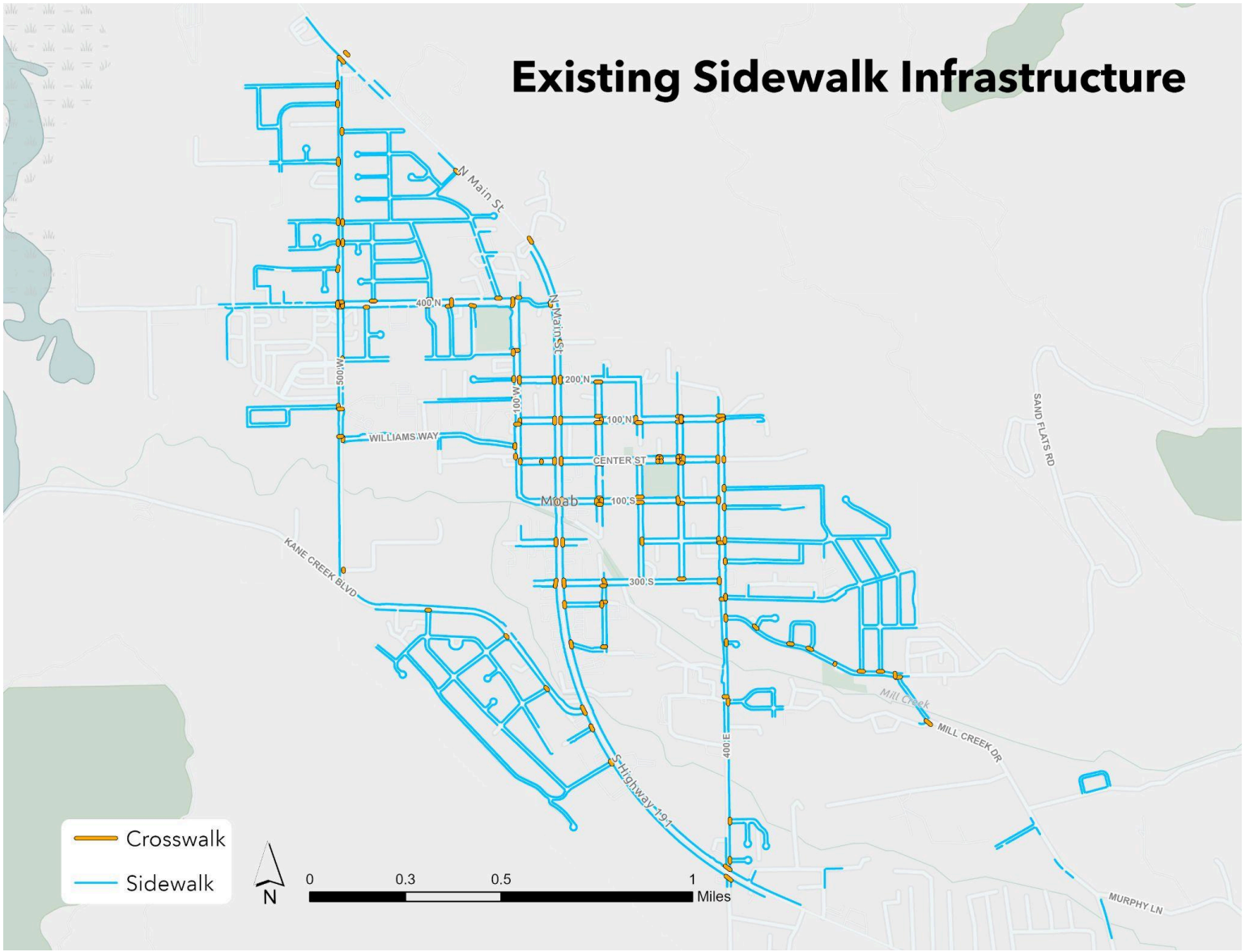


Figure 9. Existing Sidewalk Infrastructure In Moab

Table 3. Sidewalk Infrastructure Gaps

Sidewalks	Crossings
• 500 West: East Side from Kane Creek Boulevard to Mill Creek. • Mill Creek Drive: Both sides from Lasal Road to Bonita Street) • 300 East: Both sides between 300 South and 200 South. Intermittent gaps continuing along the East side to 200 North. • Highway 191: 400 East to Bittle Lane (North Side), South of Boulder Avenue • Kane Creek Boulevard: West of 500 West • Spanish Trail Road • Spanish Valley Drive	• - Kane Creek Boulevard/Aspen Drive • - Kane Creek Boulevard/500 West • - 200 North/100 East • - 100 North/200 East • - 100 South/200 East • - 100 South/300 East • - 500 West/Hale Avenue • - 500 West/Winesap Circle • - 500 West/Gala Avenue • - Mill Creek Drive/Murphy Lane • - Mill Creek Drive/Spanish Valley Drive • - Spanish Valley Drive/Spanish Trail Road • - Spanish Valley Trail/US-191 (Northwestern Sides)

Existing pedestrian infrastructure is concentrated primarily in the City of Moab's central and downtown areas, where sidewalks are present on much of the street network and crosswalks are present at key intersections on major corridors. While the downtown network is relatively well established, gaps remain where sidewalks end abruptly or are present on only one side of the street.

Crossings are equally important to a connected and accessible pedestrian network as sidewalks. A sidewalk that leads to an unsafe or unmarked crossing effectively ends at that point for most pedestrians, particularly children, older adults, and people with disabilities. Along the region's barrier roads, where pedestrians are required to cross high-speed, multi-lane, or high-volume corridors to reach destinations on the other side, crossing type or quality is as critical as crossing presence. To enhance safety and connectivity of the pedestrian network, it is recommended the City and County prioritize addressing critical geographic crossing gaps with new crosswalks and/or restriping faded crosswalk markings and striping.

As illustrated in the photograph (*Figure 10*) of the Spanish Trail Road and Spanish Valley Drive intersection, the majority of roadways in this area lack formal pedestrian infrastructure, with gravel and dirt shoulders serving as the primary walking surface. However, it is likely most residential areas in Spanish Valley and surrounding areas don't need dedicated pedestrian infrastructure to function as a safe pedestrian space. However, Spanish Valley Drive should have a safe pedestrian facility roadway crossing infrastructure in order to function as intended. The planned Spanish Valley shared-use path provides Spanish Valley Drive and the region a safer connected mobility option.



Figure 10. Spanish Trail Road and Spanish Valley Drive Intersection

Access to Destinations

Centers Travel Shed Analysis

High stress roadways create barriers and disconnectedness in a community. Barrier roads classified as LTS 3 and 4 are effectively impassable for most people walking or biking because conditions make them unsafe and uncomfortable for all but the most confident users. To illustrate this fragmentation, a travel shed analysis was conducted for the planned Regional and Neighborhood Centers that are shown within the Future Land Use Map (*Figure 11*).

A travel shed analysis identifies the destinations that can be reached from a given location within a specified travel time using the existing transportation network. For this analysis, a 0.5-mile walking radius and a 2-mile cycling radius was considered. These distances reflect how far the average person can walk or bike in 10 minutes.

Travel sheds were modeled under two scenarios: (1) the existing network, including high-stress barrier roads, and (2) a future network reflecting planned improvements along the focus corridors, which remove those barriers.

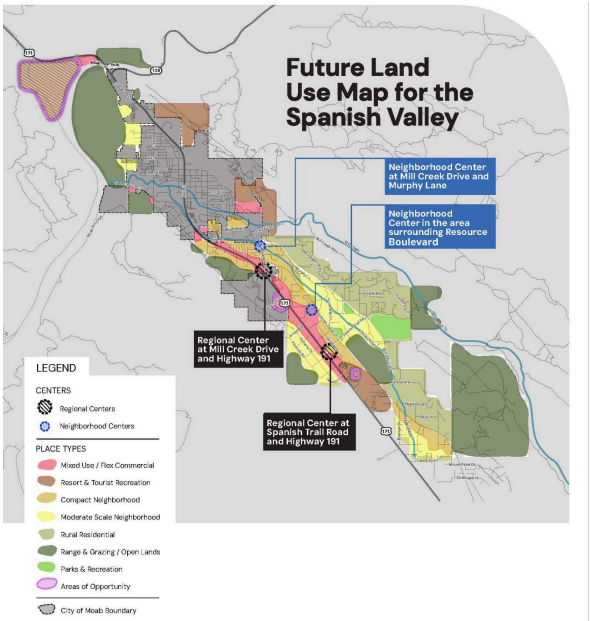


Figure 11. Future Land Use Map for the Spanish Valley



Figure 12. Centers Travel Shed (Before Focus Corridor Improvements)



Figure 13. Centers Travel Shed (After Focus Corridor Improvements)

Figure 12 shows the existing street network as it intersects with the high-stress barrier roads (LTS 3 and 4) in Spanish Valley. All four centers sit directly on or adjacent to the focus corridors, each classified as a barrier road at the point where they meet the center. The service area polygons are correspondingly tiny and fragmented.

Figure 13 models the same four centers once the focus corridors receive the planned improvements, removing them as barrier roads. The contrast is stark: Walk and bike sheds expand dramatically and merge into a nearly continuous service area running the length of the focus area. Rather than four isolated pockets, the centers begin to function as a connected string of destinations reachable by active transportation from the surrounding residential areas.

Table 4. Centers Travel Shed Population Service

Centers Travel Shed Population Service				
Destination/Cut Off	With Barrier	Without Barrier	Change	% Change
0.5 Mile	192	572	380	198%
2 Mile	55	2,228	2,173	3,951%

Because all four centers front directly onto barrier roads, this cluster is effectively near-total isolation for people walking or biking under current conditions. This is a direct contradiction of the centers' intended role as walkable, bikeable neighborhood and regional anchors, and it makes a strong case for prioritizing these specific corridor improvements in implementation. *Table 4* quantifies that gap: Removing the barriers increases the population able to reach a center on foot to 572 residents, and by bike to 2,228 residents as well as connecting the centers to the downtown area of Moab.

Impact Evaluation

Improvement Effectiveness

A separated shared use path represents the highest possible level of comfort and safety, making it appropriate for facilities intended to serve all ages and abilities. For the populations identified in this assessment including children, older adults, people with disabilities, and low-income residents. This level of protection is not simply a design preference, but a prerequisite for meaningful use.

Improved crossings along the focus corridors are equally critical for these same populations. Children, older adults, and people with disabilities are disproportionately represented in pedestrian crash statistics, in part because they require more time to cross, have reduced ability to judge vehicle speeds and gaps, and are less visible to drivers at uncontrolled intersections. High-visibility crosswalks, rectangular rapid flashing beacons, and intersection lighting directly

address the conditions that make uncontrolled crossings on high-speed, high-volume corridors most dangerous for these users.

The travel shed analysis demonstrates the scale of the accessibility problem these improvements are intended to solve. Under current conditions, barrier roads along the study area corridors severely limit the number of residents who can safely reach the key destinations by walking or biking in Spanish Valley. The centers along these corridors are effectively inaccessible with only 192 people able to walk and 55 able to bike to a neighborhood or regional center. Removing these barrier roads will expand walking access to 572 residents and cycling access to 2,228. Full implementation of the proposed corridor improvements would meaningfully close the gap between the network that exists today and the network that residents need.

It is important to acknowledge that the proposed improvements do not reach all of Moab's highest-need residents equally. The greatest concentration of disadvantaged residents, as identified in the Equity Priority Index, is on the northeast side of Moab's downtown. These neighborhoods and the residents within them would not directly benefit from the Mill Creek Drive, Spanish Valley Drive, and Spanish Trail Road improvements in the near term. Their most pressing connectivity needs are not addressed by this project, aside from improving access to the southern destinations such as the centers that do not exist at this time. The access gains projected by the travel shed analysis represent the potential of the improved network, contingent on the buildout of the destinations themselves.

Conclusions

Moab's transportation network presents significant barriers for residents most likely to walk or bike including lower income households, children, older adults, and people with disabilities. With nearly 40% of residents earning under $50,000 annually, a senior population nearly double the statewide share, and over 12% living with a disability, safe active transportation infrastructure is a necessity for a meaningful share of the community. The Level of Traffic Stress Analysis, Equity Priority Index, and Travel Shed Analysis together document where those barriers are most severe and where investment will have the greatest impact. Tourism driven growth and rising housing costs add further urgency, pushing lower income residents further from destinations while increasing traffic on already high-stress corridors.

The proposed improvements along Mill Creek Drive, Spanish Valley Drive, and Spanish Trail Road address the most critical gaps in the southern study area, where high-need neighborhoods are cut off from key destinations by the same corridors meant to connect them. Full implementation would produce dramatic gains in safe access to schools, downtown, community centers, and USU for thousands of residents who currently have no viable active transportation option. Beyond the southern corridors, the northeast neighborhoods remain the city's highest need area for future investment. Safe connected streets are not a luxury for Moab, they are the foundation for equitable access to the community's jobs, services, and public spaces.